Stan Wawrinka Says Goodbye After 23 Years in Tennis

From: BBC Tennis Mined: 2026-10-28 3 min read

Stan Wawrinka has always excited crowds, and his final **tour-level** match was no different. The 41-year-old Swiss star lost to Czech opponent Jiri Lehecka in Basel on Tuesday, before passionate home support, 7-5, 7-6 (7-2).

Fans saw his stylish one-handed **backhand**, his finger pointing to his temple, and his call for more noise. He shouted "Allez!" after winning a point he probably should not have won. There were tears as Wawrinka, his family, and his team took in the moment.

The loss ended a career of 23 years, 985 matches, and three **Grand Slam** titles. Wawrinka, a former world number three, told the ATP website he wanted to give everything, have no regrets, and give 100 percent in every match, out of respect for himself, his opponent, the **tournament**, and the fans.

Many players felt Roger Federer, Rafael Nadal, and Novak Djokovic, known as the 'Big Three,' blocked them from winning a **Grand Slam** title. That did not stop Wawrinka. At the 2015 French Open, he beat Federer in the **quarter-finals** and then beat Djokovic in the final.

Word Treasure

backhand -- A way of hitting the ball in tennis with the back of your hand facing forward.

Grand Slam -- A name for the biggest tennis tournaments.

quarter-finals -- A round in a tournament where eight players are left and the winners move on.

tournament -- A sports contest where many players compete to find a winner.

tour-level -- A match played on the main professional tennis tour.

Background you need

Tennis is a sport where players hit a ball back and forth over a net, and the biggest tournaments are called Grand Slam tournaments.

Stan Wawrinka played professional tennis for many years and won three Grand Slam titles, even though three very strong players often won them.

His last top-level match took place in his home country, in front of fans who cheered for him.

Break it down

WHO: Stan Wawrinka, a Swiss tennis star, and his opponent Jiri Lehecka.
WHAT: Wawrinka played his final tour-level match and lost, ending his long tennis career.
WHERE: In Basel, before passionate home support.
WHY: Wawrinka wanted to give 100 percent in every match, out of respect for himself, his opponent, the tournament, and the fans, and to finish with no regrets.

Why it matters

It shows that giving your best effort, even when you lose, can earn respect and leave you with no regrets.

Test what you remember

1. Who won Stan Wawrinka's final tour-level match?

- (A) Novak Djokovic
- (B) Jiri Lehecka
- (C) Rafael Nadal
- (D) Roger Federer

2. What was the score of that final match?

- (A) 7-6, 6-2
- (B) 6-3, 6-4
- (C) 6-4, 7-5
- (D) 7-5, 7-6 (7-2)

3. How many Grand Slam titles did Wawrinka win in his career?

- (A) Two
- (B) Five
- (C) One
- (D) Three

4. At the 2015 French Open, whom did Wawrinka beat in the final?

- (A) Rafael Nadal
- (B) Jiri Lehecka
- (C) Novak Djokovic
- (D) Roger Federer

5. What did Wawrinka shout after winning a point he probably should not have won?

- (A) Yes!
- (B) Let's go!
- (C) Allez!
- (D) Come on!

6. What did Wawrinka say he wanted to do in every match?

- (A) Avoid long matches
- (B) Win every point
- (C) Play only at home
- (D) Give 100 percent

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: D 4: C 5: C 6: D

Questions to think about

1. Stan Wawrinka: He wanted to give everything, have no regrets, and give 100 percent in every match.

2. Many players: They felt Roger Federer, Rafael Nadal, and Novak Djokovic blocked them from winning a Grand Slam title.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):